

Interactive Demand Map

A field guide to reading the map and using what it shows to make investment decisions.

296 Local Authorities

13 Map Layers

17+ Verified Sources

Pipeline Verified

01 *Getting started*

- 1 Open the map.** Visit map.slendeavours.org — no login, works on desktop or mobile.
- 2 Find your area.** Type a postcode into the Postcode Lookup box and press Search, or start typing a local authority name into the search field below it and pick a result. Either flies the map straight there.
- 3 Choose what to see.** The Map Layers list in the sidebar holds 13 metrics. Click one and every authority recolours to that metric; its own legend appears bottom-left of the map.
- 4 Click any authority.** A detail panel opens on the right with the full breakdown behind that colour — not just the metric you're currently viewing.
- 5 Watch the outlines.** A red border means a Section 114 notice; orange means Emergency Financial Support. These sit on top of whichever layer is active, so financial distress is always visible, whatever you're looking at.

WHAT'S CHANGED SINCE THE LAST GUIDE

The map has grown well beyond the four-view dropdown this guide used to describe. There are now **13 independently-scaled layers** instead of four, each with its own colour ramp and legend rather than one shared cream-to-red scale — darker no longer means the same thing on every layer, so the legend is now the thing to read, not memorise.

Postcode and local authority search are new. LHA rates, average house prices, long-term empty homes and CQC-registered care providers are new layers with no equivalent in the old guide.

02 *The 13 map layers*

Each layer recolours every one of the 296 authorities on the same scale, from lightest (least) to darkest (most) — except where noted, where the reading runs the other way. The sidebar groups them the same way this table does.

DEMAND & PRESSURE

LAYER	WHAT IT SHOWS	READING IT
● TA Households	Households currently in temporary accommodation	Darker = more households
● HB Specified Accommodation	Housing Benefit claimants in specified (exempt) accommodation	Darker = larger existing market
● Homelessness Spend	Total annual homelessness expenditure, 2024–25	Darker = higher spend
● Housing Register	Households on the social housing waiting list	Darker = longer register
● Care Leavers	Care leavers needing semi-independent housing support	Darker = more young people
● Domestic Violence (MARAC)	Urgent rehousing cases discussed at MARAC	Darker = more cases
● Rough Sleeping	Annual single-night rough sleeping count	Darker = higher count
● Deprivation (IMD)	Index of Multiple Deprivation 2025	Reversed — darker = <i>less</i> deprived

LOCAL HOUSING ALLOWANCE

● LHA Shared Rate	Shared-accommodation LHA rate, 2026–27, £/week	Darker = higher rate
● LHA 1-Bed Rate	One-bedroom LHA rate, 2026–27, £/week	Darker = higher rate

SUPPLY & MARKET CONTEXT

● Care Providers (SL)	CQC-registered supported living locations — the map's only supply-side layer	Darker = more providers
● Avg House Price	Land Registry HPI, all property types	Darker = more expensive
● Long-Term Empty Rate	Dwellings empty 6+ months, Council Taxbase 2025	Darker = higher rate

03 *The detail panel*

Clicking any authority opens every field below, regardless of which layer is currently selected — the panel is always the full picture, the map colour is just today's lens on it.

Temporary Accommodation

Current households

Previous year households

Year-on-year change (▲/▼)

Trend label

Housing Pressure

Housing register

Rough sleeping

HB specified accommodation

Cohort Demand

Care leavers

MARAC cases

MARAC rate (per 10,000)

Expenditure, 2024–25

B&B spend (£m)

Nightly-paid spend (£m)

Total homelessness spend (£m)

LHA Rates, 2026–27

BRMA name

Shared rate (£/week)

1-bed rate (£/week)

Care Supply (CQC)

Supported living locations

House Prices (Land Registry)

Average price, all property

Annual change

Empty Homes, Council Taxbase 2025

Long-term empty rate

Empty 6+ months (count)

Charged empty homes premium

Second homes

Context

Population

Deprivation rank (of 296)

04 *Reading the signals*

Colour intensity

Every layer has its own ramp and its own legend, bottom-left. Check the legend's two end labels before reading intensity — on most layers darker means more, but Deprivation runs the other way, and a few others (house prices, LHA rates) are just "higher value," not "worse."

■ Red border / ■ Orange border

Section 114 or Emergency Financial Support, independent of whichever layer is active. The legend box carries a matching key so you don't need to remember the colours.

■ Grey polygons

No data for the selected layer at that authority. Shown as a "No data" swatch in the legend — it is a gap, not a zero.

Panel arrows & trend

The ▲/▼ next to year-on-year change is temporary accommodation only. The trend label alongside it — rising strongly, rising, flat, falling, falling strongly, or submission gap — is the same measure read as direction rather than percentage.

05 *Making commercial decisions*

The map exists to answer one commercial question: where should you acquire or lease property for supported and exempt accommodation, and will the numbers hold up once you're there? Every layer and panel field below earns its place somewhere in that question.

WHERE TO PRIORITISE — DEMAND

TA Households, current and trend — the size of the authority's temporary accommodation caseload today, and whether it's growing. High and rising is the single strongest "there is a market here" signal on the map.

HB Specified Accommodation — the size of the exempt and supported accommodation claimant base that already exists in that authority. This sits closer to the actual market than the wider homelessness pipeline does.

Housing Register — the backlog behind today's caseload. A long register against modest TA suggests pressure that is building rather than pressure that has already surfaced in placements.

WHETHER THE NUMBERS WORK — VIABILITY

LHA Shared Rate is the floor, not the target — exempt and supported accommodation normally qualifies for a higher, uncapped Housing Benefit rate that reflects support costs. If that exempt status is ever challenged or reduced on audit, a room reverts to the Shared Rate. Read it as the worst case per room in that authority, not the expected one.

Avg House Price against LHA Shared Rate — a proxy for acquisition or lease cost, held against that floor. A high price paired with a low Shared Rate means the downside case is thin, and the model leans more heavily on the exempt rate actually holding.

Homelessness Spend, especially B&B and nightly-paid — what the authority is already paying for interim solutions it doesn't want to be paying for. High nightly-paid spend against a modest TA figure marks an authority actively looking to move households into cheaper, more stable settings — a receptive commissioner, not just a needy one.

Long-Term Empty Rate — genuinely vacant stock (not Second Homes, which the panel reports separately) can point to below-market acquisition opportunity in an authority that already shows demand elsewhere on the map.

HOW CROWDED THE MARKET ALREADY IS — SUPPLY

Care Providers (CQC) is the map's only supply-side layer — read it against a demand layer, never alone. High demand with low provider density is the least contested ground. High demand with high provider density means checking whether existing supply is actually meeting the need before assuming there's room for more.

RISK TO WEIGH IN

Section 114 notice — the authority has declared it cannot balance its own budget. This doesn't stop Housing Benefit, which is a national entitlement, but authorities under this kind of pressure are the ones most likely to be scrutinising and challenging exempt accommodation claims, or introducing local licensing to control cost. Treat it as a compliance-risk flag, not a payment-risk one.

Emergency Financial Support — a lighter version of the same signal: MHCLG is already propping up the authority's budget.

No data (grey polygon) — the authority didn't return that measure this period. Don't read it as zero, and don't rank it against authorities that did report.

06 *A five-step read*

One pass through the map, in the order the questions actually arise. Roughly two minutes per authority.

- 1 Find the caseload.** Start on **TA Households** or **HB Specified Accommodation** to see where demand already sits.
- 2 Check it is still building.** Switch to **Housing Register** for the backlog behind today's figure.
- 3 Test the floor.** Switch to **LHA Shared Rate**, holding **Avg House Price** in mind for the same authority, and check the downside case still clears.
- 4 See who is already there.** Switch to **Care Providers** to judge how contested that ground is.
- 5 Check the risk flags.** Click the authority and look for a **Section 114** or **EFS** border before committing time to it.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT

Every figure carries the date of its own source, and the panel names the period for each. Where an authority shows no data for a layer, that is a non-return, not a zero.